WRTG 621 000	**Research in Theory and Practice of Writing**
Winter 2020: Online **Chalice Randazzo** crandaz1@emich.edu	Office Hours: in office T/TH 3:30 – 5:00 pm, on Google Hangouts M/W 4:30 – 5:00 pm, and by appt Office: Pray Harrold 613A Dept Phone: 734-487-4220

Welcome to WRTG 621, Research in Theory and Practice of Writing

This course is designed to provide you with a foundation of broad types of research that we use in the discipline of writing studies (professional writing, teaching of writing, English education, technical writing, rhetoric and composition, etc.). Rather than focus on any one type of method (e.g., surveys or interviews), we focus on larger methodologies: e.g., quantitative, qualitative, mixed methods, etc.

This syllabus will provide you with a thorough overview of what you'll learn, what will be expected of you, and what you will produce as part of this course. Please read this entire syllabus carefully and contact me with any questions.

> *Research means that you don't know but are willing to find out.*
> *– Charles F. Kettering*

Learning Outcomes and Assessment Measures

Outcome: Students will…	Methods of Assessment:
Begin understanding broad methodologies as applied to the writing studies discipline and research topics	Methodology Articles posts, discussions that demonstrate competency with 1) research methods terminology and 2) broad methodological frameworks
Articulate their ethical responsibilities as researchers	CITI Certification, discussions about ethics
Develop their ability to find and analyze disciplinary texts	Literature Review, writing and discussion that demonstrates informed responses to disciplinary arguments
Develop their ability to enter into research conversations within the discipline	Literature Review, Research Project Deliverable
Prepare for future coursework in the Written Communication Program	CITI Certification, Faculty Interview, Research Project Deliverable, discussions that generate and refine future ideas

Required Course Materials & Technologies

- Textbooks:
  - *Research Design* by Patricia Leavy, ISBN 978-1462514383
  - *Telling a Research Story* by Christine Feak and John Swales, ISBN 978-0472033362
- Canvas site: This is your lifeline to class. I suggest you bookmark it: https://canvas.emich.edu
  - Canvas 24-hour helpline (call them with problems!): 844-326-6322
- Emich Email: I will contact you via Emich email on a regular basis. Please ensure your account is active, and please check it regularly.
- Adobe Reader and Microsoft Word: You will need both of these in order to receive feedback and write your materials. I have provided links to download them FOR FREE on Canvas.

Grading

Your overall grade is composed of these elements:

1. Participation: This is largely through the Canvas Discussion Posts and Responses, which are worth a SIGNIFICANT part of your overall grade. I've explained them in more detail below.
2. Project Grades: Each project will come with detailed assignment sheets and grading rubrics. You MUST have all the assignment parts to succeed on this criterion.

Challenges are what make life interesting, and overcoming them is what makes life meaningful.

– Joshua J. Marine

At the end of the semester, I'll use the following percentage scale to determine grades:

A = 93 – 100%	**B+ = 86 – 89%**	**C+ = 76 – 79%**	**D+ = 66 – 69%**	**F = 59% or below**
A- = 90 – 92%	**B = 83 – 85%**	**C = 73 – 75%**	**D = 63 – 65%**	
	B- = 80 – 82%	**C- = 70 – 72%**	**D- = 60 – 62%**	

Assignments and Point Values

Course assignments are listed in the table below with point values

Projects	Pts.	%	Participation	Pts.	%
CITI Certification	50	5	Canvas Discussion Posts (11 @ 20 pts ea)	220	22
Faculty Interview	100	10	Canvas Responses (6 @ 20 pts ea)	120	12
Literature Review	150	150	Methodology Article Posts to Canvas (1 per student – I will assign them)	60	6
Research Project Deliverable	300	30			
Projects Total	**600**	**60**	**Daily Total**	**400**	**40**

Participation: Canvas Discussion Posts, Responses, and Methodology Articles

These are worth a lot of points, and they are graded on the following components:

1. Punctuality: you cannot make them up if you miss the deadlines
2. Decorum: see below
3. Thoroughness: put some effort into your Discussion Posts and Responses. Single-sentence posts and responses signal that you were 1) unprepared, 2) distracted, or 3) unhelpful/disrespectful.

Decorum

Even though we're in an online course, the way we treat each other is still important. Therefore, I am including a "decorum" part of your grade that includes the following elements for your Canvas Discussions, Responses, and any correspondence we have with each other:

- Being courteous and professional at all times
- <u>Helpfully</u> contributing to Canvas discussions

Students who are rude, insubordinate, or unprofessional in any way will receive a deduction from the participation points. I reserve the right to deduct points as I see fit. If you encounter an issue with another student in a different, class-related forum (e.g., email instead of on Canvas), please talk to me.

Canvas Discussion Posts

These posts take the place of in-class discussion. You will respond to a question (or series of questions) that I ask. I will post the questions to Canvas with due dates, and they will usually publish at the start of a new unit (e.g., Unit 2 discussions will publish around the start of Unit 2). You may do them early, but you must finish them by their assigned due date so that other people have time to respond. Typically, a Discussion Post will be roughly 250-500 words (it's not a word count requirement, but that will keep it manageable for everyone). There might be some exceptions to this, but I will specify that in the Discussion Prompt.

Canvas Responses

This is the other half of in-class discussion: responding to each other, including to the articles that other people post later in the semester. I try to give you the weekend to respond, but watch the due dates on Canvas. Here are the steps:

1. Go to the corresponding Canvas Discussion Posts. For example, if we just finished the June 32nd Discussion Post, you would respond to that Discussion Post (not to an earlier or later post).
2. From the corresponding Discussions, find ONE Post *that no one else has responded to*.
3. Respond to that Post by the deadline. Typically, Responses should be at least 250-300 words, but that might go up depending on the Response and how energetic you're feeling.

Methodology Articles

During our methodology weeks (Unit 4), I will assign each of you to find an article that exemplifies the type of methodology we're discussing that week. You will post the article to Canvas in time for other people to read it (I have posted due dates on Canvas). If you need help with this assignment, please let me know early.

Drafts and Late Work

Drafts

I'm available to independently review rough drafts. If you want me to review your rough draft, please submit it to me AT LEAST one week before the due date (preferably earlier). This will give me time to review it, give you feedback, and still leave you with enough time to make changes.

Late Work

All work is due by noon (Michigan time) on the due date; if Canvas gives you trouble, you must email me your assignment by that day/time. Exceptions to this policy are at my discretion, and I will post any changes to Canvas. Late work will result in a grade reduction on that assignment or (if it's more than a week late without prior authorization) a zero on the assignment. I will NOT have time to remind you if you miss an assignment, so please pay attention to due dates.

How to Reach Me? Office Hours and Email

I'm willing to help you, but I won't know that you need it unless you ask! If you have a problem related to class, please don't hesitate to talk to me about it. **Don't wait until after you submit a project for a grade to talk about it**. Start asking questions during the drafting process.

I'm happy to respond to your questions via email, during my online office hours (on Google Hangouts), or in person during my on-campus office hours. Please note that I will request a rewritten email if your

tone is unprofessional. If you choose to send me email, please allow at least 48 hours for a response, and note that emails sent over the weekend will usually not be addressed until Monday.

Academic Integrity

Plagiarism occurs when a writer passes off another's words or ideas without acknowledging their source, whether intentionally or not. For example, turning another's work as your own is plagiarism. If you plagiarize in this class, you will likely receive a zero on the assignment AND your case may be passed to the university for additional disciplinary action. Because of the design and nature of this course, it will take as much (or more) work for you to plagiarize in it than it will to actually complete the work of the class. For a more detailed explanation of Eastern Michigan University's stance on academic integrity, refer to Section V.A. of the Student Conduct Code.

Important Campus Resources

Student Handbook

The EMU student handbook should be your resource for campus-wide policies, including things like grievances, incompletes, withdrawals, etc. You can find it here:
http://www.emich.edu/studenthandbook/

Disability Resource Center (DRC)

If you have a documented disability that affects your work in this (or any other) class, the Disability Resource Center can provide support for you. It is my goal that this class be an accessible and welcoming experience for all students, including those with disabilities that may impact their learning in this class. If anyone believes they may have trouble participating or effectively demonstrating learning in this course, please meet with me (with or without a Disability Resource Center (DRC) accommodation letter) to discuss reasonable options or adjustments. During our conversation, I may suggest the possibility/necessity of your contacting the DRC (240 Student Center; 734-487-2470; swd_office@emich.edu) to talk about academic accommodations. You are welcome to talk to me at any point in the semester about such issues, but it is always best if we can talk at least one week prior to the need for any modifications.

University Writing Center

The University Writing Center (115 Halle Library; 487-0694) offers one-to-one writing consulting for both undergraduate and graduate students. Students can make appointments or drop in between the hours of 10 a.m. and 6 p.m. Mondays through Thursdays and from 11 a.m. to 4 p.m. on Fridays. Students are encouraged to come to the UWC at any stage of the writing process.

The UWC also has several satellite locations across campus (in Owen, Marshall, Pray-Harrold, and Mark Jefferson). These satellites provide drop-in writing support to students in various colleges and programs. Satellite locations and hours can be found on the UWC web site: http://www.emich.edu/uwc.

AT-A-GLANCE
SEMESTER PROJECTS & TOPICS

IMPORTANT NOTES:

- See Canvas for a more detailed schedule with readings, Canvas discussions/responses, and smaller assignments
- All readings and projects are due by noon on the day listed; you can be early, but you cannot be late (email me your assignment by the deadline if Canvas gives you trouble)
- Projects, dates, and topics are subject to change; all changes will be discussed on Canvas

Overall Unit	Associated Project(s)	Week # & Dates	Topics/Lectures
Unit 1: Foundations	**Due Jan 21: CITI Certification**	1. Jan 6-10	Class welcome, discuss definitions
		2. Jan 13 – 17	Why ethics?
		3. Jan 20 – 24	Chalice's response to Canvas posts, discuss faculty interview project
Unit 2: Beginning a Project for this Program	**Due Feb 7: Faculty Interview Writeup** **Due Feb 14: Canvas Discussion Post: Problem Idea**	4. Jan 27 – 31	Reading articles for gaps, thesis, etc.
		5. Feb 3 – 7	Discuss article: "Mapping the Research Questions…"
		6. Feb 10 – 14	Identifying your own problem/ research question
Unit 3: Literature Review	**Literature Review** (due March 6, so technically the content analysis week overlaps)	7. Feb 17 – 21	Feb 18: Finding articles, vetting sources, narrowing scope Feb 21: Placing yourself within a literature review
		8. Feb 24 – 28	BREAK, even though it's sort of weird for an online course ☺
Unit 4: Methodologies and Participants/ Objects	**Due March 6: Literature Review** **Due: Methodology Articles** (You will post your article the week before the lecture, so due dates vary depending on your assigned day. Check Canvas for due dates.)	9. March 2 – 6	Content Analysis: Chalice articles
		10. March 9 – 13	Quantitative Methods: Gabrielle and Jessica articles
		11. March 16 – 20	Qualitative Methods: Scout and Vee articles
		12. March 23 – 27	Mixed Methods: Hailey and Kaitlin articles
		13. March 30 – April 3	Participatory Action Research: Maisha and Amanda articles
		14. April 6 – 10	TBD: Students' Choice
Unit 5: Deliverable	**Due April 20 by noon Michigan time: Research Project Deliverable**	15. April 13 – 20	Answers to your questions about Deliverable project and (optional) draft review